

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1999-03-29

we are happy to announce that documents were signed today establishing a chair for bahá'í Studies at The Hebrew University of Jerusalem. After visiting the Shrine of the Báb, the university's president and rector, together with other senior officers and representatives of the bahá'í world center, took part in a brief private ceremony. The signature and exchange of documents concluded discussions initiated by the university nearly a year ago. In the introduction to its formal proposal for the establishment of the chair, the university thus explained its motivation:

Three years ago, professor Moshe Sharon began to teach the history and Sacred Literature of the bahá'í Faith, on a regular basis, at the Institute of Asian and African Studies in the Faculty of Humanities of The Hebrew University of Jerusalem. As a result of professor Sharon's

293-1. See no. 290, p. 655.293.1

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659pioneering work, the university has become convinced of the importance of the field and of the need to provide an institutional basis for the continuation and development of this work on both the teaching and research levels.

it is noteworthy that in 1925, when the university was being established, the beloved Guardian wrote a letter of warm encouragement to its founders, since which time it has achieved world renown.

we offer thanksgiving at the Holy Threshold for this unanticipated manifestation of Bahá'u'lláh's ceaseless bounties.

with loving Bahá'í greetings,

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Guidance for Serving Indigenous People

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]